As a **Detroit Medical Center (DMC) surgery resident** acting as a **guest researcher at Wayne State University (WSU)** under the sponsorship of the WSU School of Medicine (SOM) Chair of Surgery, you occupy a unique, highly strategic, but legally complex position.

Because DMC is a private health system (owned by Tenet Healthcare) and WSU is a public university, your status crosses institutional boundaries. This has massive benefits for you—especially when accessing data and spinning out a company—if you set the paperwork up correctly from the start.

1. The Dual-Institution IP Matrix

Because your project involves three distinct entities (Johns Hopkins, WSU, and DMC), the intellectual property (IP) you develop will be managed under a clear hierarchy:

- **Data Origins (JHU):** Johns Hopkins provides the base data. Your upcoming Data Use Agreement (DUA) will ensure they do not own your new domain-adaptation code.
- **Algorithm & Code Ownership (WSU):** Because you are building the software extension using WSU resources (lab space, compute, or under the direction of a WSU faculty sponsor), **Wayne State University will own the patent/copyright for the software extension**. WSU's Tech Transfer Office (OTC) will handle the commercial licensing back to your future startup.
- **Clinical Testing & Validation (DMC):** As a surgical resident, when you eventually want to test your new algorithm on *local* clinical fluoroscopy streams or live C-arm sweeps, you will do so at the DMC.

2. The Critical Advantage of Your Sponsor

Having the **WSU Chair of Surgery** as your principal investigator (PI) and sponsor is your biggest administrative asset.

- **For the Incoming DUA:** Because you are technically a "guest researcher," you cannot personally be the Principal Investigator on the JHU data request. Your WSU faculty sponsor (the Chair) will serve as the **official PI on the WSU side** for the incoming Data Use Agreement.
- **The Routing:** Your sponsor's administrative staff will route the JHU request directly through WSU's internal protocol system to get it signed by the WSU Office for Technology Commercialization (OTC).

3. Immediate Action Plan for a Surgery Resident

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[Phase 1: JHU Data Ingest]       [Phase 2: Build at WSU]
[Phase 3: Validate at DMC]
  WSU Chair signs as PI.       You code the framework using    You
run a retrospective IRB
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  WSU OTC signs inbound DUA     WSU compute. Disclose new     to
test your model on local
    with Johns Hopkins.           invention to WSU OTC.
DMC fluoroscopy data.
```

Step 1: Secure the WSU Inbound Data Agreement

Do not approach DMC administration for the Johns Hopkins data. Keep the data exchange strictly **academic institution to academic institution (JHU to WSU)**. Ask your Chair's academic coordinator to submit an incoming DUA request to the **WSU OTC** ([redacted]), listing your Chair as the PI and you as the primary guest researcher.

Step 2: Establish the Resident Entrepreneur Pathway

Before you disclose the invention, ensure you are documented correctly. WSU OTC handles guest researchers regularly. When you eventually file your **Invention Disclosure Form** with WSU, you will list yourself as the primary inventor, your Chair as a co-inventor (if they contributed to the conceptual design), and explicitly note your affiliation as a *DMC Resident / WSU Guest Researcher*. This secures your right to participate in WSU's royalty-sharing policies and locks in your option to license the code into a startup.

Step 3: Map Out Your Local Validation (The Future Phase)

Once your algorithm works on JHU's data, your next logical step will be testing it on real DMC fluoroscopy streams to prove its clinical utility. At that point, you will leverage your residency position to open a **retrospective clinical protocol through the DMC/WSU Institutional Review Board (IRB)**. Because your sponsor is the Chair of Surgery, clearing the administrative hurdles to pull de-identified surgical X-rays from the DMC PACS system will be significantly streamlined.

What to tell your Chair this week

To get the ball rolling smoothly, schedule 10 minutes with your sponsor and say:

"I have mapped out the pipeline to bring the LevelCheck algorithmic data from Johns Hopkins to WSU so we can adapt it to real fluoroscopic X-ray streams. Since I am a guest researcher, we need to route an incoming Data Use Agreement through WSU OTC with you listed as the PI. Once WSU clears the data, I can build the domain-adaptation layers right here in the department."